

easier! (Except maybe Uncle Sam knocking at your door with a fistful of twenties.)

You then can review the list of agencies and programs that you have pre-qualified for based upon the answers to your questions. This feature alone can save you days and weeks, if not months and years, of time searching for possible free money sources.

If you already know where your interest lies, for example, “utilities” or “education,” you can also use the Quick Search feature on govbenefits.gov. Select the topic, which include: Awards; Counseling; Disaster Relief; Financial Assistance; Grants, Scholarships, Fellowships; Housing; Loans; Social Security/Pension; Child Care; Disability Assistance; Education; Food; Health Care; Insurance; Medicare; and Utilities. A list of all the programs in that category appears.

Click each one that interests you or that is in your state. Then you can view the details of each, or click to see if you could be eligible. You answer a few questions, and what you may be eligible for is narrowed down. The results appear on your screen before you can say, “Wow, this site is amazing.” It does the work for you. Some of the free money sources are limited to your income level, but even if you have a high income, there are still low-cost loan opportunities on this site. My hat is off to the creators of www.govbenefits.gov. Instead of searching forever, or wondering if a grant applies to you, you can get to the nitty gritty right away. That is a beautiful thing.

Free??

Yes, the best things in life sometimes really are free. Another fantastic resource available at your fingertips, another resource that is not widely known or publicized, is www.grants.gov.

Most federal agencies who offer grants post them here. You can read about the grant, see if you qualify, and download and submit your application, all online. Instead of having to search through hundreds of different agency programs, this site allows you to look for what you may be able to apply for, in one location. There are over 1000 grant programs from 26 agencies on this site; over \$400 billion to be awarded!